

# CLAT Express - September 2026: Practice Quizzes

MCQ: +1 for a correct answer, -0.25 for a wrong answer. TITA (type-in-the-answer): +1, no negative marking.

## Multiple-choice passages

### Houthi Movement Check

The Houthi movement is an armed group in Yemen that has grown into one of the most powerful forces in the country's long conflict. It began as an opposition movement during the rule of Ali Abdullah Saleh, who had governed North Yemen for many years. The movement's early history is closely tied to a series of wars in Saada, a northern region, which started after the group's founder was killed by Yemeni forces. The 2011 uprising in Yemen, part of the wider Arab Spring, forced Saleh to hand over power to a new leader. The new government then faced an economic crisis and security threats from militant groups, including an al-Qaeda branch that captured territory in parts of the south and east. The Houthis used this instability to expand their territory, moving into the capital and later into western Yemen. Their growth drew a military response from Saudi Arabia, which intervened to restore the internationally recognised government. Today the Houthis remain a central actor in the Yemeni civil war, and their control over key areas shapes regional politics and maritime security along the Red Sea.

#### Q1.

What is the official name of the Houthi movement?

- (A) Ansar Allah (Supporters of God)
- (B) Ansar al-Sharia
- (C) Al-Hirak
- (D) Al-Qaeda in the Arabian Peninsula

#### Q2.

Which religious group primarily makes up the Houthi movement?

- (A) Sunni Salafists
- (B) Sufi Muslims
- (C) Ismaili Muslims
- (D) Zaidi Shia Muslims

#### Q3.

Who was the founder of the Houthi movement?

- (A) Abdul-Malik al-Houthi
- (B) Ali Abdullah Saleh
- (C) Rashad al-Alimi
- (D) Hussein al-Houthi

#### Q4.

Read the two statements and choose the correct option.

Assertion (A): Saudi Arabia launched a military intervention in Yemen in 2015 after the Houthi takeover.

Reason (R): The Houthis claimed responsibility for a missile attack on Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

**Q5.**

Match List I with List II:

| List I                      | List II                            |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------|
| I. Hussein al-Houthi        | A. Deputy who took over from Saleh |
| II. Abdul-Malik al-Houthi   | B. President of Yemen              |
| III. Abdrabbuh Mansour Hadi | C. Current leader of the movement  |
| IV. Rashad al-Alimi         | D. Founder of the movement         |

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

**Q6.**

Consider the following statements about the Houthi movement:

- I. The Houthis oppose Israel and the United States.
- II. The Houthis are primarily composed of Sunni Salafists.
- III. The Houthis are part of the Iranian-led Axis of Resistance.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

**Q7.**

How many of the following statements about the Houthi movement are correct?

- I. The Houthis claimed responsibility for a missile attack on Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport.
- II. The Houthis captured Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport.
- III. The Saada Wars began in 2004 after the founder was killed.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

**Q8.**

In which year did the Houthis capture Sanaa, forcing President Hadi to flee abroad in 2015?

- (A) 2014
- (B) 2011
- (C) 2017
- (D) 2018

**Indus Waters Treaty: MCQ practice**

The Indus Waters Treaty is a bilateral agreement between India and Pakistan that governs how the waters of the Indus river system are shared. The treaty divides the rivers into two groups. One group is available to one country with broad rights, while the other group is mainly allocated to the other country, which keeps only limited uses such as domestic supply, some irrigation and power generation from run-of-river plants. The agreement also sets out a layered system for resolving disputes, which runs from bilateral discussion to more formal procedures. Recently, a tribunal based in The Hague held that India cannot suspend the treaty by placing it in abeyance, and that the treaty remains in force. India rejected the ruling. New Delhi says the tribunal was not properly formed and has no jurisdiction over its sovereign decisions, so it has neither recognised the

tribunal nor taken part in its proceedings. The episode has renewed debate about how the treaty's dispute procedures should work, especially when both countries pursue parallel proceedings.

**Q1.**

Which organisation facilitated the Indus Waters Treaty?

- (A) United Nations
- (B) International Court of Justice
- (C) International Monetary Fund
- (D) World Bank

**Q2.**

Under the Indus Waters Treaty, India has exclusive and unrestricted use of which rivers?

- (A) Ravi, Beas and Sutlej
- (B) Indus, Jhelum and Chenab
- (C) Indus, Ravi and Beas
- (D) Jhelum, Chenab and Sutlej

**Q3.**

Which article of the Indus Waters Treaty states that the treaty continues in force until terminated by a duly ratified treaty?

- (A) Article III(1)
- (B) Article VIII
- (C) Article IX
- (D) Article XII(4)

**Q4.**

Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are given below.

Assertion (A): The Court of Arbitration did not accept cross-border terrorism as a material breach of the treaty by Pakistan.

Reason (R): The Indus Waters Treaty contains no provisions dealing with terrorism or use of force.

Choose the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

**Q5.**

Match List I with List II:

| List I                                  | List II                                     |
|-----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| I. Permanent Indus Commission           | A. Exclusive and unrestricted use for India |
| II. Neutral Expert                      | B. Meets at least once a year               |
| III. Court of Arbitration               | C. Handles technical differences            |
| IV. Eastern rivers (Ravi, Beas, Sutlej) | D. Constituted under Annexure G             |

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C

**Q6.**

Consider the following statements about the dispute-resolution mechanism of the Indus Waters Treaty:

- I. The Permanent Indus Commission is the first institutional mechanism for addressing questions between India and Pakistan.
- II. Technical differences that the Commission cannot resolve may be referred to a Neutral Expert.
- III. The Court of Arbitration is constituted under Annexure G and has three members.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

**Q7.**

Consider the following statements about the Indus Waters Treaty and the Court of Arbitration ruling:

- I. The treaty contains provisions dealing with terrorism.
- II. The treaty continues in force until terminated by a duly ratified treaty for that purpose.
- III. India participated in the Court of Arbitration proceedings.
- IV. Interim restrictions on the Ratle project last until 90 days after the Neutral Expert's final decision.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) All of the above
- (D) Only two

**Q8.**

The Vienna Convention on the Law of Treaties is popularly known as the:

- (A) Treaty on Treaties
- (B) Charter of Agreements
- (C) Law of Nations
- (D) Code of Pacts

**Cardiff Pact MCQ set**

Political leaders from Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland signed a Memorandum of Understanding in Cardiff, asserting the principle of self-determination and calling for constitutional changes within the United Kingdom. The move has renewed debate over the UK's devolution framework, under which power is transferred from the central government to subnational institutions while ultimate constitutional authority stays at the centre. Devolution in the UK is asymmetric, because the extent and nature of devolved powers differ among the territories. The pact is a political understanding rather than a legally binding treaty. It asks Westminster to prepare, plan and facilitate constitutional change, and it affirms each nation's right to hold independence referendums. The UK government has rejected demands for new independence referendums, saying such votes need appropriate constitutional and legal authority. In the 2016 Brexit referendum, Scotland and Northern Ireland both voted to remain in the EU, which fed into these debates. Scotland and Wales would seek EU membership as new states, while Northern Ireland would rejoin the EU through unification with the Republic of Ireland. The pact is seen as the most coordinated challenge to the UK's union structure since the Good Friday Agreement.

**Q1.**

Which Sinn Fein leader signed the Cardiff Pact for Northern Ireland?

- (A) Mary Lou McDonald
- (B) Arlene Foster
- (C) Gerry Adams
- (D) Michelle O'Neill

**Q2.**

Rhun ap Iorwerth, a signatory of the pact, represents which party?

- (A) Plaid Cymru
- (B) Sinn Fein
- (C) Scottish National Party
- (D) Democratic Unionist Party

**Q3.**

Match List I with List II:

| List I                           | List II                                          |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| I. Scotland Act 1998             | A. Regulates the domestic UK market after Brexit |
| II. Government of Wales Act 1998 | B. Signed on 10 April 1998 at Belfast            |
| III. Good Friday Agreement       | C. Established the Scottish Parliament           |
| IV. UK Internal Market Act 2020  | D. Established the Welsh Legislature, now Senedd |

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D

**Q4.**

Statements about the Cardiff Pact and the UK:

- I. The Cardiff Pact was signed by leaders from Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland.
- II. The Good Friday Agreement was signed in Cardiff in 1998.
- III. The Barnett Formula is used by the UK Treasury to set changes in block grant funding for devolved administrations.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

**Q5.**

How many of the following statements about the Good Friday Agreement are correct?

- I. It was signed at Cardiff in 1998.
  - II. It allows citizens of Northern Ireland to hold Irish or British citizenship or both.
  - III. It allows reunification with Ireland to be sought at any time, subject to a referendum.
- (A) Only one
  - (B) Only two
  - (C) Only three
  - (D) None of the above

**Q6.**

In the 2016 Brexit referendum, what percentage of Northern Ireland voted to Remain?

- (A) 55.8%
- (B) 62%
- (C) 48%
- (D) 70%

**Q7.**

The Act of Union that brought Ireland into the United Kingdom was passed in which year?

- (A) 1536
- (B) 1707
- (C) 1801
- (D) 1922

### **Act provisions check**

Russia's war in Ukraine has prompted the United States to enact a law that increases economic pressure on Russia, while also extending and strengthening certain sanctions against Iran. The statute, named after Lindsey O. Graham, is built around criteria that decide which buyers of Russian energy fall within its reach. The law gives the executive branch several trade tools, including tariffs on the largest buyers of Russian oil and natural gas and tariffs on goods of Russian origin. Because the list of relevant buyers can change over time, the law provides for a periodic review carried out by the trade representative. Countries that rely only lightly on Russian gas, and that are actively cutting their imports, may qualify for a special exception. The framework's effect is also conditional, since it may be affected if Russia meets certain conditions linked to peace in Ukraine and to the stance of the Ukrainian government. For India, the measure is especially relevant because the country remains one of the major buyers of Russian crude, so Indian policymakers must weigh energy security against trade relations with the United States. Its economic effects would depend on how the tariffs are applied and how buyers respond.

**Q1.**

Compared with the original proposal, what is the enacted tariff ceiling for the largest purchasers of Russian oil and gas?

- (A) Unchanged at 500%
- (B) Raised to 1000%
- (C) Reduced to 100%
- (D) Removed entirely

**Q2.**

Assertion (A): India is significantly affected by the Act even though the law names no individual country.

Reason (R): Its criteria place major buyers of Russian crude like India within its regulatory scope.

Select the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

**Q3.**

Match List I with List II:

| List I                                                       | List II                               |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| I. Reassessment of relevant purchasers                       | A. Top 5 facilitators                 |
| II. Tariffs on facilitators of Russian oil sanctions evasion | B. Up to 500% on Russian-origin goods |
| III. Tariffs on Russian-origin goods                         | C. Through 2031                       |
| IV. Extension of Iran Sanctions Act of 1996                  | D. 180-day review cycle               |

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

**Q4.**

Consider the following statements about the Act:

- I. It authorises tariffs of up to 500% on Russian-origin goods, subject to specified exceptions.
- II. The U.S. Trade Representative must reassess relevant purchasers on a 90-day review cycle.
- III. A country importing less than 15% of its natural gas from Russia can qualify for an exception if it takes significant steps to reduce such imports.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

**Q5.**

How many of the following statements about the Act are correct?

- A. The House of Representatives passed the Act by 262 votes to 159 on 16 September 2026.
  - B. The Act extends the Iran Sanctions Act of 1996 through 2031.
  - C. The President signed the Act into law on 16 September 2026.
  - D. The Act names India directly as a country subject to its tariffs.
- (A) Only one
  - (B) Only three
  - (C) Only two
  - (D) None

**Q6.**

Under the new Act, a presidential waiver requires:

- (A) Consent from the target country
- (B) A Supreme Court order
- (C) Formal justification to Congress
- (D) Approval from the UN Security Council

**Q7.**

In February 2026, what did the U.S. Supreme Court do to the broader tariff regime that included the earlier 25% punitive tariff on India?

- (A) Upheld it
- (B) Extended it
- (C) Referred it to Congress
- (D) Struck it down

**Q8.**

The use of tariffs and sanctions to influence the behaviour of third countries is known as:

- (A) Secondary sanctions
- (B) Primary sanctions
- (C) Trade embargo
- (D) Anti-dumping measures

**Joint Commission: Practice MCQs**

Pakistan and China have set up a Boundary Joint Commission to watch over how their border management arrangements are put into practice. The body is meant to help the two sides coordinate on the everyday business of a shared frontier, including joint surveys, the flow of trade across the boundary and ties between people on either side. Its roots lie in an earlier bilateral framework on managing the boundary, which laid the groundwork for the new institution. The arrangement has drawn a firm response from India, which maintains that the Union Territories of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh are integral parts of the country. New Delhi has questioned the move and reaffirmed its own claims over the territory concerned. The dispute centres on the Shaksgam Valley, a mountainous stretch in the Karakoram region, which came under a boundary agreement signed in the 1960s. Routes and infrastructure that link Xinjiang with Pakistan add to the importance of the arrangement, because they strengthen connectivity in a sensitive part of the western Himalayas. India therefore reads the Commission as part of a wider pattern of China-Pakistan coordination close to its own northern frontiers.

**Q1.**

The Pakistan-China Boundary Joint Commission was operationalised in which month and city (inaugural meeting)?

- (A) September 2026, Islamabad
- (B) September 2026, Beijing
- (C) March 2026, Islamabad
- (D) September 2026, Kashgar

**Q2.**

The Boundary Joint Commission originates from which agreement?

- (A) 1963 China-Pakistan Boundary Agreement
- (B) 2005 CBM Protocol
- (C) 1996 Confidence-Building Measures Agreement
- (D) 2013 Pakistan-China Agreement on Boundary Management System

**Q3.**

Assertion (A): India has rejected the Pakistan-China Joint Commission insofar as it concerns territory India claims.

Reason (R): Pakistan has no locus standi to enter into arrangements involving territory India regards as under Pakistan's illegal occupation.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

**Q4.**

Match List I with List II:

| List I                                | List II                                                        |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| I. Khunjerab Crossing                 | A. Supervises implementation of border management arrangements |
| II. Shaksgam Valley                   | B. Connects Kashgar in Xinjiang with Gwadar Port               |
| III. China-Pakistan Economic Corridor | C. Area ceded by Pakistan to China under the 1963 agreement    |
| IV. Boundary Joint Commission         | D. Principal overland connection between China and Pakistan    |

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

**Q5.**

Consider the following statements about the 1963 China-Pakistan Boundary Agreement:

- I. It was signed on 2 March 1963.
- II. India has recognised it as legally valid.
- III. Pakistan transferred approximately 5,180 sq km of Shaksgam Valley to China.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I only
- (D) I and III only

**Q6.**

How many of the following statements about the Shaksgam Valley are correct?

- I. It lies north of the Siachen Glacier in the Karakoram region.
- II. It is located in Arunachal Pradesh.
- III. India has accepted the 1963 agreement over it.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

**Q7.**

The China-Pakistan Economic Corridor connects Kashgar in Xinjiang with which port?

- (A) Karachi
- (B) Chabahar
- (C) Gwadar
- (D) Hambantota

**Q8.**

Which crossing is the principal overland connection between China and Pakistan?

- (A) Khunjerab
- (B) Nathu La
- (C) Shipki La
- (D) Lipulekh

## Properties of map projections

Every world map is an attempt to show a curved surface on a flat sheet, and that task cannot be done without some loss. The Earth is not a perfect sphere, and its surface is curved in every direction. Cartographers therefore use map projections, which are systematic rules for transferring the globe onto a plane. No single flat map can keep every feature of the globe correct at the same time. Mapmakers must choose which properties to protect, such as the size of landmasses, the shapes of countries, the distances between places, or the directions between them. Some maps are made to guide travellers at sea, while others serve thematic and statistical purposes, such as showing population density. A projection that works well for one purpose may mislead when used for another. Over time, different projections have been developed, each built around a different choice of property. Readers should therefore check which property a map keeps accurate before drawing conclusions about the world from its outlines. The choice of projection is a practical decision rather than a search for one perfect map.

**Q1.**

Which property do equal-area projections preserve?

- (A) Angles
- (B) Distances
- (C) Relative areas
- (D) Directions

**Q2.**

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The Mercator projection was introduced in 1569.
- II. The Equal Earth projection was created in 1973.
- III. The Gall-Peters projection was first presented in 1855.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

**Q3.**

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Mercator projection is a cylindrical and conformal projection.
- II. The Equal Earth projection preserves relative areas.
- III. The Robinson projection preserves area exactly.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

**Q4.**

Assertion (A): The Mercator projection preserves local shapes.

Reason (R): On the Mercator grid, the stretching of parallels is matched exactly with the stretching of meridians.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

**Q5.**

Match List I with List II:

| List I                        | List II                                     |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| I. Gall-Peters projection     | A. Devised to balance size and shape        |
| II. Robinson projection       | B. Created in 1921 by a German cartographer |
| III. Winkel Tripel projection | C. Created in 2018                          |
| IV. Equal Earth projection    | D. First presented in 1855                  |

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B

**Q6.**

Which projection replaced Robinson in National Geographic Society maps in 1998?

- (A) Mercator
- (B) Gall-Peters
- (C) Equal Earth
- (D) Winkel Tripel

**Q7.**

The Earth is described as an oblate spheroid rather than a perfect sphere because of:

- (A) Its orbit around the Sun
- (B) Its tilted axis
- (C) Its rotation and uneven distribution of mass
- (D) Tidal effects of the Moon

**Q8.**

In which year was the Mercator projection introduced?

- (A) 1855
- (B) 1921
- (C) 1963
- (D) 1569

**CEC Appointment and Removal: MCQ Set**

The Election Commission of India is a constitutional body, placed under Part XV of the Constitution, that administers elections to Parliament, the State Legislatures, and the offices of President and Vice President. Its job is to ensure free and fair elections across the country. Since 1993, it has functioned as a three-member body, with one Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) and two Election Commissioners (ECs). Earlier, the President made these appointments on the advice of the Prime Minister. In *Anoop Baranwal vs Union of India* (2023), a five-judge bench directed that the CEC and ECs be appointed on the advice of a Selection Committee. Parliament then passed the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners Act, 2023 to comply with that directive. Under the Act, the Selection Committee consists of the Prime Minister, a Union Cabinet Minister and the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha. A Search Committee, headed by the Minister of Law and Justice, prepares a panel of names for the Selection Committee to consider. The Opposition has recently announced plans to move a motion in Parliament seeking the removal of the CEC. This has drawn fresh attention to the constitutional safeguards that govern the independence and removal of the CEC.

**Q1.**

Assertion (A): Under Article 326, the right to vote is a fundamental right of every adult citizen.

Reason (R): In Kuldip Nayar vs Union of India (2006), the Supreme Court held that the right to vote is statutory, not fundamental.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

**Q2.**

Match List I with List II:

| List I                 | List II                                                                         |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| I. Article 325         | A. Supervisory and controlling authority over elections and electoral rolls     |
| II. Article 326        | B. No exclusion from electoral rolls on grounds of religion, race, caste or sex |
| III. Article 324       | C. Authority to act independently where laws are silent                         |
| IV. Articles 327 & 328 | D. Adult suffrage                                                               |

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C

**Q3.**

The Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners Act, 2023 replaced which earlier Act?

- (A) Representation of the People Act, 1950
- (B) Conduct of Elections Rules, 1961
- (C) Election Commission Act, 1985
- (D) Election Commission (Conditions of Service of Election Commissioners and Transaction of Business) Act, 1991

**Q4.**

Consider the following statements about the CEC and ECs:

- I. The CEC and ECs enjoy salary and benefits equal to a Supreme Court Judge.
- II. The CEC is eligible for re-appointment after completing a six-year term.
- III. If an EC is appointed as CEC, the combined term as EC and CEC must not exceed six years.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

**Q5.**

How many of the following statements about the appointment process are correct?

- I. The Search Committee proposes a panel of five names.
- II. The Selection Committee can consider names beyond the shortlist.
- III. The Selection Committee cannot function while there are vacancies.

- (A) None
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only two
- (D) Only three

**Q6.**

Which case is regarded as a cornerstone in defining the plenary powers of the ECI under Article 324?

- (A) Mohinder Singh Gill v. Chief Election Commissioner (1977)
- (B) Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala
- (C) Maneka Gandhi v. Union of India
- (D) S.R. Bommai v. Union of India

**Q7.**

National Voters' Day is celebrated on which date to mark the foundation of the Election Commission of India?

- (A) 26 January
- (B) 25 November
- (C) 15 August
- (D) 25 January

**Q8.**

Who was the first woman CEC, known for the shortest tenure of 16 days?

- (A) V.S. Ramadevi
- (B) Meera Kumar
- (C) Sushma Swaraj
- (D) Vasundhara Raje

**Programme 2.0 and Its Pillars**

Semiconductors have become central to modern life because they power automobiles, hospitals, defence systems, aircraft, telecom networks and a wide range of consumer goods. Modern chips can hold billions of transistors within very small areas, which makes them essential for high-performance computing, artificial intelligence and digital services. Semiconductors sit at the base of the global electronics industry, a very large economic sector. The COVID-19 pandemic showed how risky it is when chip production is concentrated in a few places, and many countries have since tried to build their own capabilities. India's response is a national programme that seeks to build a complete semiconductor ecosystem, covering design, fabrication, packaging, research and skilled manpower. Its purpose is to give the sector financial and infrastructure support, so that domestic companies can grow and compete. The government hopes this will make India a dependable partner in the global value chain, in line with the vision of self-reliance and manufacturing for the world. Several areas of the programme are meant to move forward together, so that progress in design, equipment, factories and people keeps pace with one another.

**Q1.**

In which month and year was Semicon India Programme 2.0 approved?

- (A) July 2026
- (B) January 2026
- (C) December 2021
- (D) September 2025

**Q2.**

What is the enhanced outlay of Semicon India Programme 2.0?

- (A) Rs 50,000 crore
- (B) Rs 1,00,000 crore
- (C) Rs 1,27,500 crore
- (D) Rs 2,00,000 crore

**Q3.**

How many semiconductor projects have been approved across 6 States under Programme 2.0?

- (A) 12
- (B) 6
- (C) 10
- (D) 15

**Q4.**

Assertion (A): Semicon India Programme 2.0 is intended to support the semiconductor sector only for a short period.

Reason (R): It is a comprehensive, macro-level national policy framework that provides sustained, long-term financial and infrastructure support.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

**Q5.**

Match List I with List II:

| List I                                  | List II                                          |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| I. Chips to Startup Programme           | A. Support for over 5 years                      |
| II. Design-Linked Incentive Scheme      | B. Incentives based on incremental sales         |
| III. Production Linked Incentive Scheme | C. Established at C-DAC                          |
| IV. ChipIN Centre                       | D. Access to EDA tools for academic institutions |

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

**Q6.**

Consider the following statements about Semicon India Programme 2.0:

- I. Talent development is one of its six key pillars.
- II. It was launched in 2021 along with the original programme.
- III. Advanced packaging is one of its six key pillars.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

**Q7.**

Under which two programmes was the ChipIN Centre at C-DAC established?

- (A) PLI Scheme and iCET
- (B) Pax Silica and ISM 2.0
- (C) Semicon Programme 1.0 and PLI Scheme
- (D) C2S Programme and DLI Scheme

### Framework and rules check

The Unified Payments Interface has grown into a large digital payment network that handles billions of transactions every month. Running such a network requires continuous spending on technology, cybersecurity, fraud prevention, server capacity and customer support. Until now, merchants have not paid any fee for UPI and RuPay transactions, which helped small businesses

and informal sectors adopt digital payments. As the network expands, however, planners must decide how its upkeep should be funded. The answer proposed in the new framework is a fee on certain merchant payments, while everyday low-value transactions remain free. Officials have stressed that small merchants and ordinary users should not face additional costs. The fee is therefore aimed at larger merchant payments rather than at the many small transactions that make up daily life. Such a structure lets the payment ecosystem generate revenue that supports its own operation. Policymakers have sought a balance between funding the network and protecting the people who use it every day. UPI works in real time and around the clock, connecting individuals and merchants across banks. Its wide use has made it an important part of commerce for individuals and merchants alike. Because so many people rely on it, any change to how the network is priced affects a very large number of users and businesses.

**Q1.**

From which date does the new MDR framework on UPI transactions come into effect?

- (A) 1 April 2026
- (B) 15 October 2026
- (C) 1 January 2027
- (D) 15 August 2026

**Q2.**

What MDR rate applies to eligible merchant UPI transactions in the mid-value slab?

- (A) 0.02%
- (B) 1%
- (C) 0.4%
- (D) 2%

**Q3.**

In which year was the zero-MDR policy for UPI and RuPay transactions introduced?

- (A) 2020
- (B) 2016
- (C) 2018
- (D) 2022

**Q4.**

Match List I with List II:

| List I                                                                      | List II                               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| I. Mutual funds, securities, stock brokers and stock dealers                | A. MDR capped at ₹300 per transaction |
| II. Transactions of ₹75,000 and above                                       | B. Exempt from MDR                    |
| III. Railways, telecom, insurance, fuel, agricultural inputs (above ₹2,000) | C. Reduced MDR of 0.02%               |
| IV. Person-to-person (P2P) UPI transactions                                 | D. Flat MDR of ₹5 per transaction     |

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

**Q5.**

Consider the following statements about the new MDR framework:

- I. The framework applies to eligible P2M UPI transactions above ₹2,000.
- II. Small merchants receiving up to ₹1 lakh per month through UPI QR codes under the P2PM category remain exempt from MDR.
- III. MDR is a tax collected by the government, and its revenue goes to the RBI.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I only
- (D) I, II and III

**Q6.**

Consider the following statements about NPCI:

- I. NPCI is an umbrella organisation for operating and developing retail payment and settlement systems in India.
- II. NPCI is a Section 8 company under the Companies Act 2013.
- III. NPCI's headquarters is in Jaipur.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

**Q7.**

In which city is the headquarters of the National Payments Corporation of India located?

- (A) Jaipur
- (B) New Delhi
- (C) Bengaluru
- (D) Mumbai

**Finance, Trade and Customs MCQs**

Financial and trade cooperation was among the most detailed areas of the 18th BRICS Summit, which India hosted in New Delhi in 2026. Member countries discussed how cross-border trade could be made less vulnerable to currency swings and to disruptions in global financial markets. A dedicated risk-focused initiative was also discussed, linked to large infrastructure projects across the Global South and to the geopolitical risks that such projects carry. Small enterprises received particular attention, since many of them need steady cash flow to run their operations and compete in international markets. Support for young companies also formed part of the discussions. On the tax and customs side, the summit focused on sharing knowledge between national tax authorities and on joint action against smuggling and illicit financial flows, while stressing that genuine trade should continue without unnecessary obstruction. The conversations also highlighted the role of new technologies and digital solutions for development. The overall message was that a more resilient financial architecture would help developing economies manage external shocks while keeping trade flowing.

**Q1.**

Consider the following statements:

- I. The BRICS Risk Lab is located in Mumbai.
- II. The BRICS Startup Innovation Fund was proposed to support early-stage ventures.
- III. The BRICS Tax Cross-Learning Lab was launched at the summit.
- IV. The BRICS Payment Task Force seeks trade settlements in US dollars.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

**Q2.**

Which action plan was launched along with the BRICS Tax Cross-Learning Lab?

- (A) Global Value Chains Action Plan 2026-2030
- (B) Sustainable Aviation Fuels Forum
- (C) Authorised Economic Operator Action Plan 2026
- (D) Joint Roadmap for Healthy Lifestyle Promotion

**Q3.**

Consider the following statements:

- I. The BRICS Risk Lab is located in GIFT City, Gujarat.
- II. The Jaipur Consensus on MSME Financing helps MSMEs convert unpaid invoices into working capital.
- III. The BRICS Payment Task Force seeks to facilitate trade settlements in US dollars.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and II only

**Q4.**

In which place is the BRICS Risk Lab located?

- (A) Mumbai
- (B) GIFT City, Gujarat
- (C) Gurugram, Haryana
- (D) Nagpur, Maharashtra

**Q5.**

Match List I with List II:

| List I                             | List II                                       |
|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| I. BRICS Risk Lab                  | A. Support for early-stage ventures           |
| II. Jaipur Consensus               | B. Strengthening reinsurance capabilities     |
| III. BRICS Startup Innovation Fund | C. Trade settlements through local currencies |
| IV. BRICS Payment Task Force       | D. Unpaid invoices into working capital       |

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

**Q6.**

The Jaipur Consensus on MSME Financing is intended to help MSMEs convert which of the following into working capital?

- (A) Unpaid invoices
- (B) Fixed deposits
- (C) Export licences
- (D) Government grants

**Q7.**

Through which currencies does the BRICS Payment Task Force seek to facilitate trade settlements?

- (A) US dollars
- (B) Local currencies
- (C) Gold
- (D) Cryptocurrency

### **26th SCO Summit: MCQ set**

The Shanghai Cooperation Organisation has grown from a regional grouping into a wide Eurasian platform that links Central Asia, South Asia, China, Russia and Iran. Its work covers regional security, counter-terrorism, economic and connectivity cooperation, political dialogue, and cultural and people-to-people exchanges. Its leaders meet every year, and the host state rotates along with the chairmanship. The latest summit was held in Bishkek, the capital of Kyrgyzstan, and was chaired by the country's president. The gathering marked the organisation's 25th anniversary, and its theme focused on sustainable peace, development and prosperity. Leaders reviewed a large set of outcome documents on security, economy, energy, climate, institutional development and culture. The summit also reaffirmed the need for collective action against terrorism and adopted the main political document of the meeting. The summit also dealt with new mechanisms against drug trafficking and the financing of extremism, which the organisation treats as shared regional threats. A standing regional structure for counter-terrorism frames terror financing and radicalisation as collective concerns. The agenda also includes transport corridors and payment arrangements. Such a summit shows how the SCO tries to balance security concerns with its economic goals, while giving member states a common forum for their policies. It is a useful window into the organisation's priorities.

**Q1.**

The SCO Secretariat, the permanent administrative body of the organisation, is located in which city?

- (A) Tashkent
- (B) Beijing
- (C) Moscow
- (D) Bishkek

**Q2.**

In which year did Iran become a full member of the SCO?

- (A) 2017
- (B) 2021
- (C) 2023
- (D) 2024

**Q3.**

Which document was adopted as the principal political document of the 26th SCO Summit?

- (A) Bishkek Declaration
- (B) New Delhi Declaration
- (C) Tashkent Declaration
- (D) Shanghai Declaration

**Q4.**

Assertion (A): The Council of Heads of State is the highest decision-making body of the SCO.

Reason (R): The Council of Heads of Government focuses on economic and developmental cooperation.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

**Q5.**

Match List I with List II:

| List I                           | List II |
|----------------------------------|---------|
| I. Shanghai Five created         | A. 2023 |
| II. SCO Charter signed           | B. 2024 |
| III. Iran became a full member   | C. 2002 |
| IV. Belarus became a full member | D. 1996 |

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B

**Q6.**

Consider the following statements about the SCO:

- I. The Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure is based in Tashkent.
- II. The SCO was formally established on 15 June 2001 in Shanghai.
- III. India became a full member of the SCO in 2005.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

**Q7.**

Consider the following statements about the 26th SCO Summit:

- The summit was held from 31 August to 1 September 2026.
- Narendra Modi represented India at the summit.
- Kassym-Jomart Tokayev chaired the summit.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) None
- (C) Only two
- (D) Only three

**Q8.**

Which city has been designated SCO Tourism and Cultural Capital for 2026-27?

- (A) Cholpon-Ata
- (B) Samarkand
- (C) Bishkek
- (D) Lahore

**UNGA, P4M and India's Stand**

The 81st session of the United Nations General Assembly opened on 8 September 2026 in New York, under the theme 'Restoring Trust, Managing Transformation: A United Nations That Delivers for All.' On its sidelines, India's External Affairs Minister co-chaired the inaugural Partners for Multilateralism, International Law, Peace and Prosperity (P4M) Summit with European Council President Antonio Costa. The P4M framework is built upon the Carney Doctrine on middle-power solidarity, which Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney delivered at Davos. The initiative was conceived in response to the erosion of global consensus, trade weaponisation and escalating conflicts across Europe and West Asia. It was conceptualised by leaders of the European Union, Brazil, Kenya and Canada, and is co-sponsored by India, Australia and Barbados. It is designed as an open and flexible framework rather than another exclusive international bloc or permanent bureaucracy. It seeks to strengthen international law, peace, multilateral cooperation and inclusive prosperity, and to enable countries from different political traditions to cooperate on reforming multilateral institutions and addressing common global challenges. Meanwhile, India used the same period of diplomacy to argue for reformed multilateralism, stressing risks to supply chains, the need for more inclusive decision-making and comprehensive reform of the United Nations Security Council.

**Q1.**

India's 4F crisis refers to disruptions involving which four areas?

- (A) Fuel, Food, Fertiliser, Finance
- (B) Fuel, Fibre, Forest, Finance
- (C) Food, Fertiliser, Freight, Farming
- (D) Finance, Fintech, Fuel, Fisheries

**Q2.**

Match List I with List II:

| List I                           | List II                                     |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| I. Arctic Council                | A. Expedition of Hans Egede arrived in 1721 |
| II. Visegrad Group (V4)          | B. Established in 1996 (Ottawa Declaration) |
| III. Pituffik Space Base         | C. Established in 1991                      |
| IV. Greenland as a Danish colony | D. Formerly known as Thule Air Base         |

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D

**Q3.**

Consider the following statements:

- I. India called for international frameworks and guardrails for AI, space security and digital technologies.
- II. India pursued UNSC reform through the G7 and G20 groupings.
- III. India highlighted the disproportionate impact of 4F disruptions on developing countries.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I and III only

**Q4.**

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Visegrad Group was established in 1991.
- II. The Visegrad Group takes its name from a town in Hungary.
- III. The Arctic Council was established in 2001 through the Ottawa Declaration.

How many of the statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the statements

**Q5.**

Who is the current chair of the Arctic Council for 2025-2027?

- (A) Denmark
- (B) Canada
- (C) Norway
- (D) Russia

**Q6.**

At the V4 plus India meeting, the V4 unanimously supported India's candidature for which status?

- (A) Membership of the G7
- (B) Chairmanship of the Arctic Council
- (C) Permanent membership of the UN Security Council
- (D) Membership of the European Union

**Reading the Index**

Gender equality is often discussed in terms of laws and policies, but measuring it is a separate challenge. One widely cited tool is the Global Gender Gap Index, which is published every year as a flagship report. Its purpose is not simply to count how many women hold particular positions. Instead, it asks how far each country has moved toward closing the disparities between women and men. This focus on gaps rather than absolute outcomes shapes the whole report. Each country receives a numerical score, and these scores allow nations to be compared on a common yardstick. One end of the range signals complete equality, while the other end signals absolute inequality. The scores can also be presented on a more familiar scale, where the highest value stands for full parity. Because the report is repeated each year, observers can see whether countries are moving forward or falling behind. Readers should remember that a ranking captures relative progress among the countries covered. It does not, by itself, describe the daily experience of women in any single society. Understanding the method behind the scores is therefore as important as reading the final table.

**Q1.**

Which country retained the first position for the 17th consecutive year?

- (A) Finland
- (B) Norway
- (C) Iceland
- (D) Sweden

**Q2.**

In which year was the Global Gender Gap Report introduced?

- (A) 1971
- (B) 2006
- (C) 2000
- (D) 2015

**Q3.**

Consider the following statements about the Global Gender Gap Report:

- I. The report was introduced in 2006.
- II. The report was introduced in 2015.
- III. The report is an annual flagship publication of the World Economic Forum.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I and III only

**Q4.**

Assertion (A): The World Economic Forum was founded by Klaus Schwab in 1971.

Reason (R): The World Economic Forum is a Switzerland-based think tank and advocacy group.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

**Q5.**

The 2026 Global Gender Gap Report is which edition?

- (A) 10th
- (B) 15th
- (C) 20th
- (D) 25th

**Q6.**

How many of the following statements about the index's dimensions are correct?

- I. Economic Participation and Opportunity is one of its dimensions.
- II. Educational Attainment is one of its dimensions.
- III. Social Security Coverage is one of its dimensions.
- IV. Political Empowerment is one of its dimensions.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

**Q7.**

How many countries does the 2026 index cover?

- (A) 135
- (B) 145
- (C) 146
- (D) 148

**Sarvekshan rankings check**

The Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan is an annual assessment of the cities covered under the National Clean Air Programme. It was first launched in 2022-23. The cities are grouped into three categories according to their population: Category I covers the largest cities, Category II covers mid-sized cities and Category III covers the smallest cities in the assessment. The assessment focuses on seven areas of measures: road dust management, solid waste management, vehicular emissions, industrial emissions, construction and demolition waste, commercial sources, and public awareness and outreach initiatives. Cities are evaluated on five key parameters: ambient air quality, source apportionment, action plan implementation, institutional capacity and public participation. Swachh Vayu Diwas 2026 was observed on 7 September 2026, which coincides with the International Day

of Clean Air for Blue Skies. The fifth set of Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan Awards was presented on that occasion. The awards recognise cities and wards that have shown effective air pollution mitigation measures under the programme. The 2026 edition also introduced a new feature: ward-level rankings, which show how individual wards compare with one another. City-level results are reported within each category, which means cities are compared with others of similar population.

**Q1.**

How many of the following statements about the 5th Sarvekshan rankings are correct?

- I. Indore secured the 2nd position in Category I.
- II. Angul secured the 1st position in Category III.
- III. Rourkela secured the 1st position in Category II.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

**Q2.**

Which two cities shared the second position in Category II (population 3-10 lakh)?

- (A) Rourkela and Amravati
- (B) Firozabad and Guntur
- (C) Indore and Jabalpur
- (D) Angul and Talcher

**Q3.**

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- I. Lucknow was the top-performing city in Category I (population above 10 lakh).
- II. Jabalpur secured the second position in Category I (population above 10 lakh).
- III. Talcher secured the third position in Category III (population below 3 lakh).

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

**Q4.**

Which city secured the 2nd position in Category I (population above 10 lakh) in the 5th Sarvekshan 2026?

- (A) Lucknow
- (B) Jabalpur
- (C) Indore
- (D) Kota

**Q5.**

Match List I with List II:

| List I                                      | List II         |
|---------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| I. Category I (population above 10 lakh)    | A. Amravati     |
| II. Category II (population 3-10 lakh)      | B. Kalinganagar |
| III. Category III (population below 3 lakh) | C. Rourkela     |
| IV. Category II, third position             | D. Lucknow      |

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

**Q6.**

Which city was ranked 30th in Category I of the 5th Sarvekshan 2026?

- (A) Delhi
- (B) Jabalpur
- (C) Indore
- (D) Lucknow

**Q7.**

Which city was the leading performer in Category III (population below 3 lakh)?

- (A) Angul
- (B) Talcher
- (C) Rourkela
- (D) Kalinganagar

### **EOS-05 launch and imaging check**

Earth observation satellites help governments see what is happening on the ground without sending anyone to the site. ISRO has added a new satellite to this list, known in the booklet as EOS-05 and also called GISAT-1A. The satellite was lifted into space by an indigenous heavy-lift rocket from an Indian launch centre, and the mission is treated as a test of the country's launch capability. The spacecraft is described as an advanced Earth observation satellite meant for continuous and high-frequency imagery. Such imagery supports disaster response, border watch and farm monitoring. As the booklet notes, the choice of orbit determines geographical coverage, image resolution, revisit time and the mission application. The same imagery can help plan emergency responses and track weather events. The sections that follow describe the satellite, the orbit it uses and the other missions that share its theme. Students preparing for competitive examinations should note that such questions usually test the specific numbers, stages and names attached to a mission, since these details are easy to confuse.

**Q1.**

Which launch vehicle carried EOS-05 into orbit?

- (A) PSLV-C60
- (B) GSLV-F17
- (C) LVM3-M4
- (D) SSLV-D3

**Q2.**

What is the approximate mass of EOS-05?

- (A) 1,200 kg
- (B) 3,500 kg
- (C) 4,000 kg
- (D) 2,367 kg

**Q3.**

Assertion (A): EOS-05 can monitor large geographical areas persistently.

Reason (R): It operates from a sub-geosynchronous orbit at about 35,786 km, the altitude of geosynchronous orbit.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

**Q4.**

Match List I with List II:

| List I                    | List II                                           |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| I. Medium Earth Orbit     | A. Appears fixed over one point of Earth          |
| II. Very Low Earth Orbit  | B. Relatively consistent solar illumination       |
| III. Geostationary Orbit  | C. Very high resolution, greater atmospheric drag |
| IV. Sun-Synchronous Orbit | D. Used by GNSS such as GPS and Galileo           |

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D

**Q5.**

Consider the following statements about the GSLV-F17 launch of EOS-05.

- I. The satellite was launched from the Satish Dhawan Space Centre, Sriharikota.
- II. GSLV-F17 marked the 19th operational flight of the GSLV.
- III. The third stage of GSLV-F17 is a solid-propellant stage.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

**Q6.**

How many of the following statements about EOS-05 are correct?

- I. It is designed to carry only radar imaging instruments.
- II. It is designed for operations from a sub-geosynchronous orbit about 35,786 km above Earth.
- III. It carries optical and infrared imaging payloads.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

**Q7.**

What is the nickname of EOS-05?

- (A) Naughty Boy
- (B) Sky Watcher
- (C) Vayu Netra
- (D) Eye in the Sky

**Q8.**

Why is GEO-based Earth observation useful compared with LEO?

- (A) It provides persistent, wide-area monitoring instead of intermittent passes
- (B) It offers higher resolution than LEO
- (C) It uses less fuel
- (D) It has lower communication delay

**Disputes at Sea, Land and Lake**

Several disputes over sea, land and naming drew attention this month. A Pakistani naval vessel, PNS Hunain, collided with the Indian Navy warship INS Kolkata in the North Arabian Sea. India described the conduct of the Pakistani vessel as unsafe, said the incident took place in international waters, and lodged a diplomatic protest. The episode became both a maritime and a diplomatic

dispute. A similar collision had taken place in the Gulf of Aden in June 2011, involving INS Godavari and PNS Babur.

The two countries already have a bilateral agreement from 1991 that is meant to reduce the possibility of accidents between their naval platforms. It is a confidence-building measure intended to prevent misinterpretation of military activities.

Elsewhere, the long-running Falklands dispute between Argentina and the United Kingdom has resurfaced, with disagreements over sovereignty and oil exploration around the islands. The United Kingdom says it has exercised continuous and peaceful authority over the islands, while Argentina considers British control illegitimate and refers to the territory as Las Malvinas. The islands are a British Overseas Territory.

In North America, the United States has moved to rename Lake Ontario as Lake America. Canada opposed the proposal, pointing to the name's Indigenous Wendat origins and its long use. Lake Ontario is one of the five Great Lakes and lies between Ontario province and New York State.

**Q1.**

Under the 1991 India-Pakistan Agreement on Advance Notice of Military Exercises, what is the minimum distance that naval ships and submarines of the two countries should keep from each other while operating in international waters?

- (A) 3 nautical miles
- (B) 5 nautical miles
- (C) 12 nautical miles
- (D) 1 nautical mile

**Q2.**

On which date was the 1991 India-Pakistan Agreement on Advance Notice of Military Exercises signed?

- (A) 16 March 1991
- (B) 1 June 1991
- (C) 6 April 1991
- (D) 15 August 1991

**Q3.**

Assertion (A): The 1991 India-Pakistan agreement aims to reduce the possibility of accidents involving naval platforms of the two countries.

Reason (R): Naval ships and submarines of the two countries are allowed to approach within 3 nautical miles of each other while operating in international waters.

In the light of the above statements, choose the correct answer from the options given below.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

**Q4.**

Match List I with List II:

| List I               | List II                                                     |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| I. Falklands Islands | A. Links Lake Ontario with Lake Erie                        |
| II. Lake Ontario     | B. Establish internationally recognised rules of navigation |
| III. COLREGs         | C. Lie roughly 480 km from Argentina's eastern coast        |
| IV. Welland Canal    | D. Smallest of the Great Lakes by surface area              |

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

**Q5.**

Consider the following statements about Lake Ontario:

- I. Lake Ontario is the largest of the five Great Lakes by surface area.
- II. Lake Ontario does not border the state of Michigan.
- III. The Niagara River is the principal source of water entering Lake Ontario.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

**Q6.**

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The COLREGs establish internationally recognised rules of navigation and collision avoidance for vessels at sea.
- II. Argentina became independent from Spain in 1830.
- III. Lake Ontario is the easternmost and final lake in the Great Lakes system.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

**Q7.**

In the 2013 referendum held in the Falkland Islands, approximately what percentage of participating islanders voted to retain the islands' status as a British Overseas Territory? (in per cent)

- (A) 99.8
- (B) 96.4
- (C) 88.0
- (D) 51.2

**Q8.**

As successor to the colonial possessions of which country in the region does Argentina argue that it inherited territorial claims over the Falkland Islands?

- (A) Portugal
- (B) Britain
- (C) France
- (D) Spain

## Blue Bonds and the Navier-Stokes Claim

Financial markets are looking beyond conventional projects towards the health of the seas and rivers. A new category of debt instrument is emerging to pay for work that keeps marine and freshwater ecosystems usable and protected over the long term. India plans to join this market through a bond issued by a company that focuses on the maritime sector. The bond will be arranged by a bank's capital markets arm, which has been appointed as arranger. Governments elsewhere have already experimented with similar tools, so the idea is not entirely new.

Science also produced a headline this month. A technology company said that an advanced artificial intelligence model had produced a proposed solution to a long-standing puzzle about how fluids move. Such claims are checked with formal tools that test every step of an argument. The puzzle concerns the equations that describe the motion of water, air and honey, and it belongs to a small group of famous challenges that a mathematics institute has highlighted.

Those equations are not merely theoretical. Engineers rely on them when they design aircraft and automobiles, and scientists use them to predict weather and model currents in the ocean. Progress on the puzzle would therefore matter far beyond mathematics.

### Q1.

India's proposed blue bond is best described as a sub-category of which broader instrument?

- (A) Green bonds
- (B) Sovereign bonds
- (C) Municipal bonds
- (D) Infrastructure investment trusts

### Q2.

In 2000, the Clay Mathematics Institute designated the Navier-Stokes problem as one of how many Millennium Prize Problems?

- (A) Five
- (B) Six
- (C) Eight
- (D) Seven

### Q3.

Consider the following statements:

- A. Sagarmala Finance Corporation Limited is India's first maritime sector-specific NBFC.
- B. Ocean-current modelling is one of the applications of the fluid equations.
- C. The Navier-Stokes problem was designated a Millennium Prize Problem in 2010.
- D. Seychelles issued the world's first sovereign blue bond in 2019.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

### Q4.

The OpenAI proof claim was reportedly checked using Lean. In the booklet, Lean is described as what?

- (A) A fluid-flow simulation software
- (B) A computer-based proof assistant
- (C) A maritime finance platform
- (D) A prize committee for mathematics

**Q5.**

Consider the following statements about the Navier-Stokes problem:

- I. The fluid equations are based on conservation of mass and Newton's second law of motion.
- II. The Clay Mathematics Institute designated this problem in 2000 as one of seven Millennium Prize Problems.
- III. The fluid equations describe the motion of water and honey, but not air.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and II only

**Q6.**

Which country implemented a Debt-for-Ocean Swap in 2021 to support marine conservation?

- (A) Seychelles
- (B) Mauritius
- (C) Belize
- (D) Maldives

## Type-in-the-answer passages

### Peace Deals Recall

Yemen's civil war has moved through phases of fighting, negotiation and fragile truces. After the Houthis took over large parts of the north, a Saudi-led coalition joined the conflict to support the government that is recognised internationally. Renewed fighting caused civilian displacement and disrupted local supply lines. Negotiators from the warring parties then tried to find a way out of the fighting through a package of agreements. The Stockholm Agreement was one such deal, and it covered several issues, including the city of Hodeidah and its ports. Ceasefire terms for Hodeidah set out how armed forces would move away from the ports and how the ports would be run by local forces. The agreements were meant to reduce violence and open a path to a wider political settlement. Diplomats kept returning to the talks table, hoping that partial deals could be turned into lasting arrangements.

**Q1.**

The Stockholm Agreement was reached on which day of December 2018? (day of the month)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q2.**

Under which UN Security Council resolution number was the Stockholm Agreement endorsed?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q3.**

How many main components does the Stockholm Agreement have? (number)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q4.**

Under the Hodeidah ceasefire, the withdrawal of forces is overseen by a committee chaired by which organisation? (acronym)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q5.**

Under the Hodeidah ceasefire, which party was to withdraw from the ports and Hodeidah City? (one word)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q6.**

In which year did the Saudi-led military intervention in Yemen begin? (year)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q7.**

From midnight on which day of December 2018 did the Hodeidah ceasefire take effect? (day of the month)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Dispute mechanism: typed answers**

The Indus Waters Treaty sets out a graded system for handling disagreements between India and Pakistan. A standing bilateral body is meant to handle questions through discussion and exchange of information. Where a disagreement is technical rather than legal, it can be passed to an independent expert whose appointment is arranged through an outside institution. Formal legal disputes are meant to reach a court of arbitration, which is constituted under a formal annex to the treaty and has a fixed number of members. Both countries have at times run proceedings along two tracks at the same time, which has raised concerns about conflicting outcomes. When one such track was paused and later resumed, the order of steps became a central point of argument. India holds that the treaty must be followed in sequence, so that a legal tribunal takes up a case only after the earlier steps are exhausted. Pakistan has pursued its own route through arbitration. Meanwhile, restrictions on construction at one hydroelectric project remain linked to the outcome of the expert's work and stay in force for a period after the expert issues its final decision. The dispute has shown how much depends on the procedural order laid down in the treaty.

**Q1.**

How many members does the Court of Arbitration under the Indus Waters Treaty have? (in number)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q2.**

Under which Annexure of the Indus Waters Treaty is the Court of Arbitration constituted?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q3.**

Which institution's mechanism is involved in appointing the Neutral Expert? (name the institution)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q4.**

In which year did the World Bank pause both the arbitration and Neutral Expert processes?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q5.**

In which year did the World Bank allow both processes to move forward?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q6.**

Which 850 MW hydroelectric project on the Chenab River has restrictions imposed by the tribunal? (name the project)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q7.**

Ratle project restrictions remain relevant until how many days after the Neutral Expert's final determination? (in days)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

### Union history TITA set

The United Kingdom was built in stages, and its constituent nations joined it at different times. Wales was brought into the English legal and political system through an Act of Union passed in the sixteenth century. The English and Scottish parliaments were united in 1707, creating a single new state. Ireland joined later, when another Act of Union brought it into the United Kingdom. Most of Ireland became independent after an Anglo-Irish War, while six counties in the north remained within the United Kingdom as Northern Ireland. Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland now each have devolved institutions, but the extent of their powers differs. Scotland's Parliament and Wales's legislature were set up by separate Acts of Parliament, and Westminster retains ultimate constitutional authority over all of these arrangements. After Brexit, Northern Ireland came to share a land border with an EU member state. New checks were then introduced between Great Britain and Northern Ireland, and these checks angered Unionists who believed they undermined Northern Ireland's position within the UK. This layered history explains why devolution differs across the nations, and why these tensions continue to shape political debate.

#### Q1.

In which year was the Act of Union that brought Ireland into the United Kingdom passed?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

#### Q2.

In which year was Wales incorporated into the English legal and political system?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

#### Q3.

In which year did most of Ireland become independent?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

#### Q4.

Name the Act of Parliament that established the Scottish Parliament.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

#### Q5.

What was the state called that was formed when the English and Scottish parliaments were united in 1707? (use the full name)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

#### Q6.

In which year was the Good Friday Agreement signed?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

### Legal tools check

Trade measures linked to Russian energy purchases raise questions about how long they will last. A measure that has been passed by the legislature and signed into federal law carries greater legal permanence. American trade policy also relies on older statutes that give the government tools to respond to foreign practices. One of these allows the trade representative to examine unfair conduct by other countries. Another permits restrictions on imports when they are seen as a risk to national security. The government has also used tariffs on certain imported metals, and it has applied tariffs connected with goods produced through forced labour. For a country like India, such instruments matter because they change the cost of exports and make trade talks more complicated. Officials and businesses often watch these tools closely because a single measure can affect many sectors at once. Understanding the legal route behind each tariff helps explain why some measures last longer than others.

**Q1.**

In which year did the U.S. Supreme Court strike down the broader tariff regime that included the earlier 25% punitive tariff on India? (year)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q2.**

In which year was the Trade Expansion Act, under which Section 232 operates, enacted? (year)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q3.**

Under which section of the Trade Act, 1974 can the USTR investigate foreign trade practices? (section number)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q4.**

On which legal instrument was the earlier 25% punitive tariff on India based? (two words)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q5.**

What must accompany a presidential waiver under the new Act when it is placed before Congress? (two words)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q6.**

What tariff rate, in per cent, has the United States imposed on steel, aluminium and copper products? (number)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q7.**

What tariff rate, in per cent, does India face in connection with a U.S. investigation into goods produced using forced labour? (number)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Disputed Lines: TITA Set**

The boundary between India and China has never been fully settled, and disagreements over it have produced a long chain of confrontations. Two stretches of the frontier sit at the heart of the dispute. One lies in the high region of Aksai Chin, which the two sides understand differently, each relying on its own historical line. The other involves Arunachal Pradesh, which China describes as part of Tibet while India administers it as a full state. The line in that area was agreed at a convention attended by Tibet, China and British India, but China refused to accept it, arguing that Tibet could not conclude treaties. Armed encounters and standoffs have since erupted in several places, including mountain passes in Sikkim and Arunachal and the plateau where three countries meet. A practical dividing line emerged after the war of the early 1960s, and both sides have since tried to prevent escalation through talks and confidence-building measures. Local commanders meet at designated points to resolve friction on the ground, while senior commanders negotiate withdrawals when standoffs become serious. Yet incidents continue in the high mountains. Understanding these disputed lines is therefore essential for reading news about the border, since each claim carries a long history behind it.

**Q1.**

China administers Aksai Chin as part of which autonomous region? (name the region)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q2.**

In which year was the McMahon Line demarcated? (year)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q3.**

On which date in 1962 did China unilaterally declare a ceasefire? (day and month)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q4.**

Into how many sectors is the Line of Actual Control divided? (number)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q5.**

Which Chinese Premier introduced the term 'Line of Actual Control' in 1959? (name)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q6.**

Which sector of the LAC covers Arunachal Pradesh and Sikkim? (name the sector)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q7.**

For how many days did the 2017 Doklam plateau standoff last? (in days)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Equal Earth and the Correct the Map campaign**

A world map has to make choices, and the projection behind it decides which features look accurate. Many wall maps have long used a projection that suits navigation but makes landmasses far from the Equator look larger than they really are. Equal Earth is a newer world projection designed to display the entire globe while keeping the relative sizes of landmasses accurate. It avoids the severe, jarring shape distortions found in earlier equal-area maps. A campaign called Correct the Map has urged the wider use of equal-area projections, and two advocacy groups run it. Regional bodies have endorsed the idea, and the matter was taken up by the United Nations General Assembly. The resolution received wide support, but it also drew opposition and abstentions in the vote. Such a resolution carries political weight, yet it does not have binding force. Schools, publishers and governments are therefore free to decide whether to change the maps they use. Maps shape how people picture the size and position of countries. Choosing a projection is therefore a practical decision that depends on the purpose of the map. Readers should check what a map is designed to show before drawing conclusions from it. Only time will show whether the new map becomes common in classrooms and official documents.

**Q1.**

Which country led the UN General Assembly 'Correct the Map' resolution? (name the country)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q2.**

How many countries supported the resolution, including India? (in number)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q3.**

Which country voted against the resolution? (name the country)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q4.**

How many countries abstained from the vote on the resolution? (in number)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q5.**

Which regional organisation endorsed the Correct the Map campaign in August 2025? (give the name)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q6.**

In which year was the Equal Earth projection created? (in year)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q7.**

Which Togolese Foreign Minister is associated with the resolution? (give the full name)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

### **Electoral Rolls and SIR: Typed Answer Set**

An electoral roll is the official list of individuals eligible to vote in a given election within a specific jurisdiction, and being listed on it is a legal prerequisite for casting a vote in India. The publishing and updating of electoral rolls are the joint responsibility of the Election Commission of India, the state's Chief Electoral Officer and the state's election commission. The Commission has broad authority over voter list management, and no individual may be excluded from electoral rolls on grounds of religion, race, caste or sex. The Commission can direct a fresh revision of rolls, which may be intensive, summary or a combination of both. An intensive revision involves a complete and fresh preparation of rolls through house-to-house enumeration, and it is done when the rolls are outdated, inaccurate or need complete rebuilding. A summary revision is a routine annual updating of existing rolls, while a special revision is undertaken in exceptional cases. The Special Intensive Revision is a focused, time-bound house-to-house verification of voters by Booth Level Officers, aimed at adding missing voters, removing ineligible ones and correcting entries. Such a revision excludes non-citizens and includes citizens aged 18 or above who are ordinarily resident in the constituency. Courts have also held that names cannot be removed from voter lists merely on suspicion, and the right to vote is treated as a statutory right rather than a fundamental one.

**Q1.**

In which year did the earliest Special Intensive Revision listed in the booklet begin? (year)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q2.**

How many documents from the prescribed list can be submitted in the Bihar SIR to prove date or place of birth? (number)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q3.**

In which year was the last SIR held in Bihar? (year)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q4.**

The 61st Amendment (1988) reduced the minimum voting age from how many years? (in years)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q5.**

Which 1995 case struck down ECI guidelines that allowed deletion from electoral rolls on mere suspicion? (name of the first party)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q6.**

Under which section of the Representation of the People Act, 1950 can the ECI direct a fresh revision of electoral rolls? (section number)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q7.**

Under which Article does the ECI have supervisory and controlling authority over elections and electoral rolls? (article number)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

### **Schemes and Partnerships in Brief**

India's push into semiconductors uses several kinds of government support rather than a single measure. Some tools are aimed at manufacturing, with financial incentives for companies that set up production within the country and attract large investments. Others are aimed at design, because a country that can design its own chips depends less on imported technology. Academic institutions and start-ups are part of this effort, as they need access to specialised resources, training facilities and design infrastructure. Research bodies are also building their own processors, including designs based on an open instruction architecture, which adds to domestic technical strength. Support for design firms is planned over a long stretch so that they can move from early development to full deployment. Diplomacy plays a role as well. India has signed a strategic technology agreement with a major economy to expand cooperation in research, business and defence industry. It has also joined a coalition of countries that wish to protect the supply of critical minerals, manufacturing capacity and digital infrastructure. Together these steps reflect an attempt to lower dependence on other countries and to become a dependable part of the global chip supply network, which matters greatly in a world where supply disruptions can hurt many industries at once.

**Q1.**

In which year did India sign the India-US iCET deal? (year)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q2.**

What budgetary provision, in crore rupees, has been made for FY 2026-27 to support India Semiconductor Mission 2.0? (number)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q3.**

For how many years does the Design-Linked Incentive scheme provide support to semiconductor design companies? (in years)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q4.**

What is the name of the coalition India joined to strengthen global semiconductor supply-chain resilience? (two words)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q5.**

What range of domestic production-linked incentives does the PLI scheme offer to mobile phone and specified component makers? (in per cent)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q6.**

At which institution was the ChipIN Centre established? (short name)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

### **Exemptions and caps check**

Digital payments work best when small transactions stay cheap for everyone who uses them. Small businesses need protection from additional payment processing costs. Policymakers have therefore tried to protect the smallest users while still asking larger participants to share the cost of running the network. The new approach separates payments into groups. Some payments remain free regardless of who sends or receives them, while others attract a charge only when they are large. Certain sectors that provide essential services are placed in a separate group, where a fixed charge per transaction applies rather than a percentage. Investments routed through mutual funds and securities are charged at a lower rate, because that rate is meant to encourage greater use of digital payments in formal financial markets. Several upper limits also protect users. A single ceiling prevents very large payments from carrying an unlimited fee, and small merchants who earn only modest amounts through QR codes each month are exempt from the charge altogether. Together, these rules aim to keep ordinary digital payments affordable while the payment infrastructure keeps growing.

**Q1.**

Which type of UPI payment between two individuals is exempt from MDR? Give the standard abbreviation.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q2.**

Up to what amount, in rupees, are P2M UPI payments exempt from MDR, including through RuPay debit cards?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q3.**

What monthly receipt limit, in lakh rupees, keeps small merchants under the P2PM UPI QR category exempt from MDR?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q4.**

What is the maximum MDR, in rupees per transaction, for transactions of ₹75,000 and above?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q5.**

What reduced MDR, in per cent, applies to payments involving mutual funds, securities, stock brokers and stock dealers?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q6.**

What is the name of the category that contains mutual funds and securities in the MDR table? Give two words.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

### **Agriculture, Health and Climate TITA**

The 18th BRICS Summit also produced outcomes in areas that touch everyday life, including farming, public health, transport and climate. Member countries discussed how to make food supplies steadier, particularly when global prices move sharply. A proposed commodity marketplace was among the ideas, intended to make trade in farm produce among member countries more predictable. Cooperation on seeds, plant material and farm inputs was also highlighted, along with a farmer-centred framework for sharing information. In health, the focus was on promoting active living and on building support for mental well-being through shared training. Innovation in medicine was another theme, with attention to developing solutions that could be deployed widely in developing regions. On transport and logistics, members agreed to share technical knowledge about building resilient supply systems. Climate concerns were reflected in discussions about cleaner fuels for aviation, urban infrastructure able to withstand extreme weather, and the protection of natural carbon sinks such as tropical forests. Culinary exchanges were also part of the summit, with regional produce showcased to delegates. Together, these outcomes reflected an effort to link economic cooperation with practical improvements in people's livelihoods.

**Q1.**

By which year does BRICS aim to launch the BRICS Grain Exchange? (year)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q2.**

Which Indian institution leads the Training Hub Network for mental well-being?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q3.**

Which state's MedTech Zone spearheaded the BRICS BioDesign Centre? (name of state)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q4.**

In which year does the Joint Roadmap for Healthy Lifestyle Promotion end? (year)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q5.**

In which year does the Global Value Chains Action Plan end? (year)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q6.**

Which BRICS network focuses on cooperation relating to seeds, germplasm and agricultural inputs?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q7.**

Delegates were served Koraput Coffee from which Indian state?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**SCO origins: typed answers**

The organisation's story begins with a grouping built to settle old disputes. Its early members were mainly concerned with borders between neighbours and with building trust among their armed forces. Over time, the group admitted new members and widened its agenda from border questions to security, trade and people-to-people contact. Membership has grown in stages, and some countries first took part as observers before becoming full members. Today the organisation has a secretariat that handles routine administration, and a council of heads of state that takes the most important decisions. Its counter-terrorism work runs through a regional structure based in Uzbekistan. The chairmanship moves between member states each year, which keeps the

organisation's leadership spread across the region. Its leaders also meet at the annual summit, where the chair passes from one member to the next. The organisation's objectives include strengthening mutual trust, good-neighbourliness and mutual support on security and counter-terrorism. It also aims to promote cooperation in trade, economy, connectivity, transport, digital economy and environmental protection. Over the years, members have built a shared set of institutions, and their common work is coordinated through the secretariat and the heads of state council. The Shanghai Cooperation Organisation describes its goals as peace, security, stability, economic cooperation and cultural exchange in the SCO region.

**Q1.**

In which year was the Shanghai Five created? (year)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q2.**

Which country joined the Shanghai Five in 2001, leading to the SCO's establishment? (country)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q3.**

In which year did the SCO Charter enter into force? (year)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q4.**

In which year did Belarus become a full member of the SCO? (year)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q5.**

In which year did India become an SCO observer? (year)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q6.**

How many outcome documents did leaders approve at the 26th SCO Summit? (number)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q7.**

Which city is the headquarters of the SCO? (city)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Greenland and the US Agreement**

Greenland, the world's largest island, lies between North America and Europe, which makes it a linchpin in Arctic and trans-Atlantic security. It is one of Denmark's two autonomous territories, and it is self-governing. Greenland lies within the GIUK gap, a strategic chokepoint for monitoring naval movements in the North Atlantic. The United States maintains Pituffik Space Base, formerly known as Thule Air Base, which is a pivotal facility for monitoring potential missile threats. A new trilateral agreement among the United States, Denmark and Greenland builds on earlier defence arrangements while recognising Greenland's right to self-determination. It provides for expanded activities at Pituffik and for US military access to Narsarsuaq in southern Greenland, along with broader operational access across Greenland's land, air and maritime areas. The agreement restricts military presence by non-NATO states through joint approval, and it does not transfer sovereignty over Greenland to the United States. Beyond security, Greenland holds large untapped reserves of rare earth minerals, and melting Arctic ice is opening new maritime corridors such as the Transpolar Sea Route. Denmark's firm stance highlights the tension between territorial sovereignty and the strategic ambitions of major powers.

**Q1.**

In which year did the US-Denmark Defence Agreement concerning Greenland formalise American military access to the island? (year)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q2.**

In which year did the expedition led by Hans Egede arrive in Greenland, after which it became a Danish colony? (year)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q3.**

What was the amount of the 1946 US offer to Denmark for an outright purchase of Greenland? (in million US dollars, number only)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q4.**

Which island, recognised as the world's northernmost point of land, is located in the Greenland region? (name)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q5.**

How many Arctic nations are members of the Arctic Council? (number)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q6.**

Since which year has Greenland had the right to declare independence through a referendum? (year)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q7.**

Which Indian Arctic research station, established in 2008, is located at Ny-Alesund in Svalbard, Norway? (one word)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Global Progress Check**

Global progress toward gender equality is measured through rankings and overall scores, and the latest edition offers a mixed picture. The top of the table has stayed remarkably stable, with the same country holding the leading position for a long stretch. Several nations close behind it have also kept strong positions. Movement at the bottom of the table is watched closely, since the lowest-ranked countries show the widest gaps. Across the world, the overall gap has narrowed, but only slightly from the previous year, which means change is slow. Leadership remains a challenge in every sphere. Women hold only a small share of chief executive roles, and their presence in emerging technology work is also limited. Career patterns add to the picture, since women are more likely than men to take breaks from work linked to parenting. One new country joined the group of top performers for the first time in this edition. Taken together, these trends suggest that closing gaps requires sustained effort rather than occasional improvement.

**Q1.**

For how many consecutive years has Iceland retained the first position? (in years)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q2.**

Which country ranked last among the 145 countries covered in the 2026 index?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q3.**

What share of the overall global gender gap has the world closed? (in per cent)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q4.**

At the present rate of progress, approximately how many years would complete global gender parity take? (in years)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q5.**

What per cent of CEO positions globally are held by women? (in per cent)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q6.**

Which country entered the global top 10 for the first time in 2026?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**NCAP numbers check**

The National Clean Air Programme is a national-level strategy launched by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change to address air pollution through coordinated interventions across sectors. It covers non-attainment cities along with million-plus cities. Non-attainment cities are those that have failed to comply with the National Ambient Air Quality Standards over a specified assessment period. Its initial target was a 20 to 30 per cent reduction in PM10 and PM2.5 concentrations by 2024. Later, the target was enhanced to a reduction in particulate matter concentration by 2026, and the revised target has not been fully achieved. Annual PM10 concentrations are compared with the base year to measure progress. Progress is also tracked through the PRANA portal, which was launched to track NCAP progress and regulate air pollution in non-attainment cities. The National Air Quality Index is a tool for communicating air quality status to people in terms that are easy to understand. The Graded Response Action Plan is a set of emergency measures that come into effect when air quality shifts from Poor to Very Poor. Other measures include the Bharat Stage VI vehicle emission standards, which replaced BS-IV norms nationwide.

**Q1.**

In which year was the National Clean Air Programme launched by MoEFCC? (year)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q2.**

How many of the 130 cities recorded a reduction of 40% or more in particulate matter concentration? (in number)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q3.**

How many cities met the prescribed NAAQS under NCAP progress? (in number)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q4.**

In which year was the baseline for NCAP targets set? (year)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q5.**

To what percentage reduction in particulate matter concentration by 2026 was the NCAP target enhanced? (in per cent)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q6.**

How many cities achieved reductions of more than 20% in FY 2025-26? (in number)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q7.**

How many cities recorded reductions in annual PM10 concentrations in 2025-26 compared to 2017-18? (in number)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**NISAR radar check**

The NASA-ISRO Synthetic Aperture Radar satellite, called NISAR in short, is a partnership between two space agencies and is described as the first joint Earth-observation satellite of its kind between them. Conventional cameras depend on visible light, but radar works differently. A synthetic aperture radar sends microwave pulses toward the ground and builds images from the returning signals, so it can produce sharp pictures in darkness and through clouds. The satellite is meant to study changes in the solid Earth. Its images help track surface deformation, which is useful for understanding earthquakes, volcanic activity and landslides. The same data can also support monitoring of floods, biomass, deforestation, crop health and soil moisture. The booklet calls its radar technology among the finest synthetic aperture radar systems ever designed. Its large receiving antenna and wide imaging swath make it suitable for mapping large surface areas in three dimensions. Because the satellite can detect minute ground shifts, its data is used for tectonic and structural analysis.

**Q1.**

What is NISAR's designed mission life, in years?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q2.**

At what altitude, in km, does NISAR orbit Earth?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q3.**

After how many days does NISAR's repeat cycle complete? (in days)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q4.**

What is the width of NISAR's imaging swath, in km?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q5.**

How many radar frequency bands does NISAR use? (in number)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q6.**

Which type of low Earth orbit does NISAR use?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q7.**

What is the name of NISAR's imaging mode that captures wide 3D high-resolution images?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Economy and Schemes: Key Numbers**

Several economic and infrastructure stories were in the news this month. The Union Cabinet approved a scheme to promote new surface coal and lignite gasification projects that produce

syngas, building on the National Coal Gasification Mission launched in 2021. Gasification converts coal into a gaseous fuel instead of burning it directly, and the scheme is part of a wider national objective for coal gasification capacity by 2030. Eligible projects receive financial assistance on their plant and machinery, subject to ceilings for each project, each product and each entity.

In electric mobility, NITI Aayog and World Resources Institute India released the India Electric Mobility Index 2025. It evaluates how States and Union Territories are progressing towards electric mobility on a scale of 0 to 100, using three pillars: transport electrification progress, charging infrastructure readiness and EV research and innovation. Delhi retained the highest overall position.

A long-pending inter-state project, the Kishau Multipurpose Dam, has also moved forward. It is planned on the Tons River, a tributary of the Yamuna, and several States and Union Territories have reached agreement on its implementation.

Urban statistics were discussed too. The Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs told a Parliamentary panel that the criteria for identifying a Census Town may no longer reflect India's changing urbanisation. A Census Town is treated as urban for Census purposes even though it may not be a formally notified urban local body.

Finally, India's foreign exchange reserves reached a record high, a rise linked mainly to inflows through RBI's concessional swap arrangements tied to FCNR(B) deposits.

**Q1.**

What percentage of the cost of the water component will the Union Government provide as Central Assistance for the Kishau Multipurpose Dam Project? (in per cent)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q2.**

Up to what percentage of expenditure on plant and machinery will the government provide as financial assistance under the new coal and lignite gasification scheme? (in per cent)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q3.**

How many performance indicators does the India Electric Mobility Index 2025 use to evaluate States and Union Territories?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q4.**

How many States/UTs are participating in the Kishau Multipurpose Dam Project?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q5.**

What minimum population must a settlement have to qualify as a Census Town under the criteria introduced for the 1981 Census? (in persons)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q6.**

After the recent rise, what global rank did India attain in foreign exchange reserves? (ordinal)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q7.**

What weight, in per cent, does the Transport Electrification Progress pillar carry in the India Electric Mobility Index 2025? (in per cent)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

### **Schemes, Events and Honours**

September brought a mix of schemes, events and honours. The country marked International Literacy Day with a national festival that focused on adults who never learned to read. The programme is meant to build basic reading, writing and calculating skills among learners who have passed the age of school.

Water also featured in the news. A major conference on water management brought together experts, officials and delegates to discuss solutions that can withstand a changing climate. The event is a flagship initiative of a central government ministry, and it has been rebranded for the current year.

In cinema, the nation's highest honour is named after a pioneer of Indian films. The award recognises an individual's outstanding contribution to the growth and development of Indian cinema. A veteran actor from Karnataka was selected for the 2024 award and became the second Kannada actor to receive it.

Beauty pageants made headlines too. The Miss World contest crowned a new titleholder from the Dominican Republic at its latest edition, and the next edition has already been planned for a future year in another country. An Indian contestant secured a place among the top forty.

**Q1.**

In which year was the Dadasaheb Phalke Award instituted?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q2.**

In which year was Raja Harishchandra, directed by the award's namesake and regarded as India's first full-length feature film, made?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q3.**

In which city did the ULLAS Mela mark the conclusion of the International Literacy Day 2026 celebrations?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q4.**

In which year was India Water Week first conceptualised, before its 2026 rebranding? (year)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q5.**

In which financial year does the implementation period of the ULLAS scheme end? (financial year)

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q6.**

In which Vietnamese city was the 73rd edition of Miss World held?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

**Q7.**

Which country will host the next Miss World edition, scheduled for 2027?

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

